

Introduction

Imagine a bespectacled shadowy figure sitting somewhere at an undisclosed location. Ordinarily, going by his attire or personality this person could be just your average Joe, but in this context he could be considered a suspicious and dangerous figure because of the context of what he is doing. He could be a cyber-stalker, a notorious hacker, or someone who is currently engaged in a coordinated cyber terrorism attack. Or perhaps (a comparatively lesser evil) he could be simply a mass mailer. In the course of performing all of these actives, he is for all practical purposes a cyber criminal.

This Fasttrack aims to introduce you to the technological transformation of crime from the streets to the networked superhighways of cyberspace. Driven by greed, revenge, obsession, megalomania, and even a righteous intent to protect national borders, cybercrime today has the potential to affect the lives of each and every one of us. Unlike ordinary criminals, this new breed of this criminals needn't even be in your vicinity. For instance in the case of phishing, scam artists from another continent may prey on your greed and get you to part with your money.

In this Fasttrack we start off with defining what cybercrime is all about and acquaint you with the various types of tools cybercriminals use. Next we show you how to effectively monitor your PC and other devices for suspicious activity. But being affected at the personal level is not the only thing that cybercrime involves. There are wars of the digital era being fought in cyberspace. This comes under cyber terrorism and cyber warfare.

The laws relating to cybercrime are quite complex. Under the framework, simple things we unwittingly do online may be punishable and severe offenses may go unnoticed. Hence the need to know more about the how cybercrime is policed in the Indian context and what laws govern Indian cyberspace.

We round up the Fasttrack with practical knowledge, and safety tips to keep yourself safe from being a victim of cybercrime. Happy reading and stay safe. 